The Art of War

Sun Tzu

1 · Laying Plans

- 5 factors: the Way, Heaven, Earth, the Commander, Method
- Compare the forces before fighting
- All warfare is based on deception

2 · Waging War

- A long war exhausts the state
- Quick victory, not a long campaign
- Forage on the enemy's land

3 · Attack by Stratagem

- Winning without fighting is the ideal
- Attack the strategy, then the alliances, the army and, last, the cities
- Know the enemy and know yourself

4 · Tactical Dispositions

- First make yourself invincible
- Wait for the enemy's vulnerability
- Win before you fight

5 · Energy

- Direct and indirect forces
- Endless combinations
- Strength of the whole, not the individual

6 · Weak Points and Strong

- Arrive first and impose the ground
- Attack where the enemy does not defend
- Adapt like water

7 · Maneuvering

- Turn the detour into the direct route
- Communication: banners and drums
- Do not attack rested or motivated troops

8 · Variation in Tactics

- Some orders must not be obeyed
- Weigh advantage and risk
- 5 fatal faults of the commander

9 · The Army on the March

- Read the signs of the terrain and the enemy
- Discipline with humanity

10 · Terrain

- 6 kinds of terrain
- 6 causes of defeat that are the commander's fault
- Care for soldiers as your own children

11 · The Nine Situations

- From dispersive ground to desperate ground
- With no way out, troops fight with everything
- Speed and surprise

12 · The Attack by Fire

- 5 targets of fire
- Do not act out of anger
- Move only if there is an advantage

13 · The Use of Spies

- Information is worth more than battles
- 5 kinds of spies
- The double agent is the most valuable

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